

John Cho

4th Year Software Co-op Engineering Student at McMaster University

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Education

Bachelor in Software Engineering, McMaster University

Sept 2022 – April 2027

- **GPA:** 3.9/4.0
- **Coursework:** Computer Architecture, Discrete Math, Object-Oriented Programming, Data Structures and Algorithms, Linear Optimization, Digital Signals and Systems, Control Systems

Extracurriculars

Software Team Lead, [McMaster Mars Rover Team](#) – Hamilton, ON

Nov 2022 – present

- Led a team of 10-12 people to enhance and maintain rover stack using tools such as Kanban and git
- Used ROS 2 to create complex control systems on Jetson AGX Orin such as SLAM, point-to-point navigation, differential GNSS RTK, and inverse and forward arm kinematics to complete various on-rover tasks at competition
- Developed custom firmware for STM32 motor controller boards with PID over CAN bus using STM32CubeIDE for drivetrain and arm actuation
- Team placed 1st in Canada (4th overall) at [Summer CIRC 2023](#) and 2nd overall at [Winter CIRC 2024](#)

Programming Leader, [FIRST Robotics Competition](#) – LaSalle, ON

Oct 2018 – June 2022

- Member and leader of the programming section for FRC Team 772, the [Sabre Bytes](#) and Drive Team Operator for 2021-2022 season
- Wrote commands to control drivetrain, flywheel, turret, and intake subsystems of robots using WPILibC++
- Mainly responsible for PID and vision control of turret to automatically aim and shoot balls into Hub using data from motor encoders and limelight cameras

Experience

Embedded Developer Intern, [Geotab](#) – Oakville, ON

Jan 2025 - Dec 2025

- Developed embedded GNSS/IMU software for fleet telematics devices using POSIX C and NuttX to support harsh driving detection and sensor calibration
- Troubleshoot and fixed customer-facing issues for Amazon GO devices by debugging legacy GNSS firmware and pinpointing root cause through drive tests
- Wrote tools to query trip logs and monitor performance of up to 1000 field devices using Python for validating new firmware releases

Camp Counselor, [STEM Camp](#) – Hamilton, ON

July 2023 – Aug 2023

- Managed a group of 20 to 30 kids interested in learning STEM, teaching basic programming concepts using MakeCode
- Helped campers utilize micro:bit microcontrollers to control motors, servos, pumps, and sensors to complete a variety of tasks such as making automated robots to plant seeds, basic wind turbines, and water plant dispensers

Projects

[Minecraft Turing Machine](#)

April 2024 – May 2024

- Created a Turing Machine using Minecraft redstone, complete with a functional memory tape and 8-bit register to store current state, write symbol, and tape direction
- Program is a FSM (Finite-state machine) with 14 states which accepts the language or set of strings $\mathcal{L} = \{a^n b^n c^n \mid n \geq 0\}$
- Utilized many concepts in digital systems and discrete math such as combinational logic, k-maps, formal language theory, finite automata, and state minimization

[Pure Pursuit Path Controller](#)

Feb 2022 – March 2022

- Implemented a controller of the pure pursuit path following algorithm for a differential drive system
- Works by inputting a set of waypoints, then calculates a smooth path for the robot to follow while feeding back constant odometry data to keep track of its position relative to the path
- Used by FIRST Robotics Team 772 to successfully traverse and collect balls around the field in autonomous mode (video demonstration [here](#))

Skills

Languages: C++, C, Java, Python, Verilog, Bash, YAML, UML, SQL

Technologies: ROS, ROS 2, micro-ROS, Git, CMake, SSH, Arduino IDE, STM32CubeIDE, Linux, Docker, SLAM, PID, SPI, I2C, CAN, UART, SonarQube, Maven, NuttX